36. Quoted in Christophe Jaffrelot, *The Hindu Nationalist Movement and Indian Politics: 1925 to the 1990s* (New Delhi: Penguin, 1999), p. 329.
37. On this, see former Madhya Pradesh chief minister and senior Congress leader Kamal Nath's statement giving credit to Rajiv Gandhi for 'opening the locks' of the Babri Masjid, for saying in 1989 that 'Ram Rajya' (rule of Ram) will be created and that Ram Mandir should be built. Video interview available at: https://youtu.be/4ARhuayfOr4.
38. BJP, *Opening Remarks by Shri LK. Advani: Resolutions Adopted by National Executive: National Executive Meeting,* 9, 10 and 11 June 1989, Palampur.
39. Atal Bihari Vajpayee, L.K. Advani, Murali Manohar Joshi, Kushabhau Thakre, Bangaru Laxman, Jana Krishnamurthi, Rajnath Singh all started their careers with the RSS. Venkaiah Naidu also joined the RSS and started his political career with the ABVP, the RSS-affiliated student wing. Nitin Gadkari, considered close to the RSS, also started his career with the ABVP. Amit Shah joined the RSS as a student and then the ABVP. J.P. Nadda also started with the ABVP.
40. 'I am a state-level worker, he [Togadia] works at the international level now, his canvas is wider', Narendra Modi interview with N.K. Singh, *The Indian Express*, 1 November 2007.
41. A.B. Bardhan, 'Swayamsevak Vajpayee', *Observer*, 19 September 2000.
42. Rajesh Ramachandran, 'Here's why', *Hindustan Times*, 12 March 2000.

CHAPTER 12 The Growth of the RSS

1. The RSS was founded by Dr Keshav Baliram Hedgewar on Vijayadashami day, 27 September 1925, at his house in 'Sukravari' in Nagpur. The name 'Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh' was selected on 17 April 1926 during a meeting at Hedgewar's house, from a list of four names: Jaripatka Mandal, Bharat Uddharak Mandal, Hindu Swayamsevak Sangh and Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh. The tradition of commencing daily activities with a salutation to the saffron flag (bhagwa dhwaj) and